Data Platform Governance Policy

Section 1: Data Classification

All data ingested into the platform must be classified into one of three tiers: Public, Internal, or Restricted. Restricted data includes any personally identifiable information, financial account details, or health-related records. Access to Restricted tier data requires explicit approval from the Data Governance team and is logged in the audit trail for a minimum of seven years.

Section 2: Retention Requirements

Structured transactional data is retained for a minimum of five years to satisfy financial reporting and audit requirements. Unstructured documents, including scanned records and support tickets, follow the same retention schedule as the structured data they reference. Streaming event data is retained in raw form for ninety days before being aggregated into summary tables and the raw events are purged.

Section 3: Cross-Border Data Transfer

Data originating from customers in the European Union must remain within EU-based cloud regions unless an approved Standard Contractual Clause is in place. Any pipeline that moves EU customer data across regions must be reviewed by Legal before deployment to production.

Section 4: Incident Response

In the event of a suspected data quality or security incident affecting Restricted tier data, the on-call data engineer must page the Data Governance lead within fifteen minutes of detection and freeze any downstream pipeline writes until the scope of the incident is confirmed.